specialists. Amid all the things that went on, I frankly have had trouble remembering many specifics of the day-to-day events and meetings of that period, at least in the degree of detail that subsequent interest in the events has demanded. In this book, I have set out to describe everything I remember about the Iran-Contra affair.

At the same January 7 meeting of the National Security Council at which I approved the executive order involving Libya, John Poindexter and the NSC staff proposed pressing ahead with the Iranian initiative. This meant approving an additional shipment of TOW missiles, but with a new emphasis on negotiating directly with moderate members of the Iranian government rather than with the go-betweens.

In retrospect, I think there were probably always a few questions in my mind about the reliability of the people we were dealing with during the negotiations that began after Bud McFarlane's visit to me at the hospital in the summer of 1985. Several times, they promised that hostages would be released momentarily, and nothing happened. Still, Bill Casey said that the world of covert operations was full of people who were less than angels. The people we were dealing with *had* managed to get out one hostage, and, since we had made our connection with them, there had been no major terrorist acts committed against Americans by the Hizballah.

In early January, I was assured again that Ghorbanifar and company had good connections in Iran. Warts and all, they were our best hope for getting the hostages out, so I decided to proceed with the initiative despite a deep division within the cabinet and staff: Ed Meese, Bill Casey, and especially John Poindexter—who became the principal manager of the initiative after McFarlane retired—argued for going ahead; Cap Weinberger and George Shultz remained very much opposed, with Shultz especially strong in his